

Dear Admissions committee,

RE: RECOMMENDATION FOR BRIAN SAIKWA.

I first met with 'Brio' when we were just twelve years when we attended *irua* together; the traditional circumcision ceremony for the Kikuyu community. It was there that we formed this unbreakable bond even as we got to build and share our traditional hut, *thingira*, as we transitioned into young adults. Life and karma thereafter decided that I would be pleasantly stuck with this amazing and crazy character for my whole life. We would attend the same high school, play basketball together, share the same bunk and class, live in the same estate and basically enjoy the ups and downs of our teenage lives with my best friend.

I am quite excited I can tell you to be the one to frame up this 'guy' and paint his otherwise not seen side of my best friend to you. It would only be fair considering I am the one who had to listen to him speak on and on about your prestigious college with the excitement of one who won a lottery.

I know Brian has probably shown you his serious and committed side in other ways but I would like to tell you that he is the funniest and fun person ever! If I was to show you our conversations, 90% would be the laugh emoji and 10% moments of dry and crazy jokes. He just has this natural ability to make the atmosphere brim with happiness making him a joy to be around. Brio has this outgoing and relatable personality that makes him have many friends and become a favorite and close confidant of peers, kind of like a celebrity but without the drama. It's like when we are in every social gathering and while there are many social groupings forming, Brio always seemed to fit into every group. When there was that new kid that was too shy to talk to anyone, Brio was there to make them feel like they belonged. You can't seem to hold him down, he is always on the move relating to everyone and everyone and adding to the fact that he is always talking and making stories. Yeah! That's my bestie.

Brio has this determination and commitment within him. He almost never gives up on anything that we undertake. He always wants to experiment new things and he is one of those people who have so many hobbies that you wonder if they have 48 hours instead of 24 in a day. It's usually a perk being next to him because he ensures that you do what he tries, whether absurd or impossible. The excitement and satisfaction are what always pushes him to keep on trying small things and growing in learning them. He is always persevering in the toughest situation; like when we would borrow old roller blades and he would insist on riding them even after falling and bruising himself a couple of times. He would laugh and get up and try over and over again.

To be honest I owe my success in my final high school exams on Brian to a great extent. This is not only due to the fact that Brio loved helping people and working in groups helping everyone get concepts, it was what he did during the final weeks to the paper. While all other students who were bright in academics would be panicking trying to perfect their grades, Brian took his time to stay with me till late hours of the night helping me understand and improve my work till I scored an A in my final paper. He changed my life forever impacting on my future.

If Jeffy comes to your school, please remind him he owes me a trip to Hollywood. He is just this determined, energetic, focused, charismatic and wholesome individual and most of all, a blessing to all.

Bottom-line, I can assure you that Brian will bring positive impact and contribute meaningfully and unforgettably to your school community as he does to my life.

Yours,

Jeff Maina.

Best-friend.